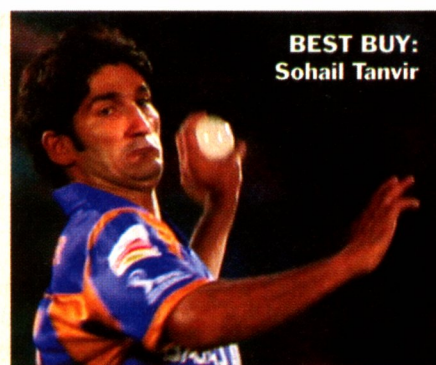


GOOD BARGAINS VS POOR INVESTMENTS

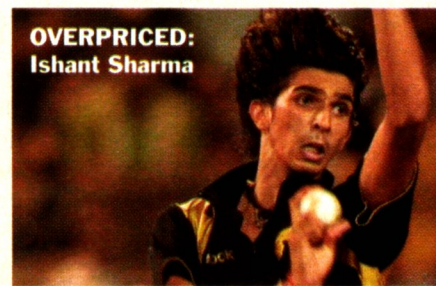
GOOD BARGAINS	PRICE	M	RUNS	AVG	S/R	W	AVG	ECO
Venugopal Rao (Hyderabad)	\$ 30000	11	288	36.00	137.14	2	68.50	9.79
A Nayar (Mumbai)	\$ 30000	14	206	25.75	149.28	1	68.00	9.71
Manpreet Gony (Chennai)	\$ 30000	16	35	35.00	152.17	17	26.06	7.38
Shaun Marsh (Mohali)	\$ 30000	11	616	68.44	139.68	-	-	-
Sohail Tanvir (Jaipur)	\$ 100000	11	36	12.00	124.14	22	12.09	6.46
Shane Watson (Jaipur)	\$ 125000	15	472	47.20	151.77	17	22.53	7.07
Umar Gul (Kolkata)	\$ 150000	6	39	13.00	205.26	12	15.33	8.18
D. Bravo (Mumbai)	\$ 150000	9	178	29.67	132.84	11	21.09	8.19

POOR INVESTMENTS	PRICE	M	RUNS	AVG	S/R	W	AVG	ECO
Ishant Sharma (Kolkata)	\$ 950000	13	11	11.00	100.00	7	47.00	7.80
Jacques Kallis (Bangalore)	\$ 900000	11	199	18.09	108.74	4	77.75	9.06
Shahid Afridi (Hyderabad)	\$ 675000	10	81	10.13	176.09	9	25.00	7.50
Manoj Tiwary (Delhi)	\$ 675000	9	104	26.00	122.35	-	-	-
Mohammed Kaif (Jaipur)	\$ 675000	16	176	16.00	102.92	-	-	-
Herschelle Gibbs (Hyderabad)	\$ 575000	9	167	18.56	109.15	-	-	-
Ricky Ponting (Kolkata)	\$ 400000	4	39	9.75	73.58	-	-	-



BEST BUY:
Sohail Tanvir

SHAHBAZ KHAN



OVERPRICED:
Ishant Sharma

SUBIR HALDAR

cricket can hope for is that ventures like the IPL are closely regulated and remain just a one-month marketing mania, a meal ticket to finance longer forms of the game. In an environment like India though, arguing with the forces of the market using history and tradition as currency, is a losing proposition.

In its most ideal form, the IPL can help home-grown talent be seen by a wider audience and raise standards and intensity across the domestic game in India. But with the urgency to win remaining paramount, team owners are unlikely to think in such broad philanthropic terms.

The IPL franchisees are now doing their numbers and trying to consolidate their brands. The Royals and the Delhi Daredevils have overseas tours and academies in mind. The Royals want their academy to be a centre that scouts and trains young talent from across the country. This academy, Emerging Media Executive Chairman Manoj Badale specifies, would have nothing to do with the official Future Cricket Academy already in operation under the Rajasthan Cricket Association in Jaipur.

Under director of cricket operations T.A. Sekhar, the Daredevils will consider setting up a world-class bowling academy under their franchise. Other means of remaining

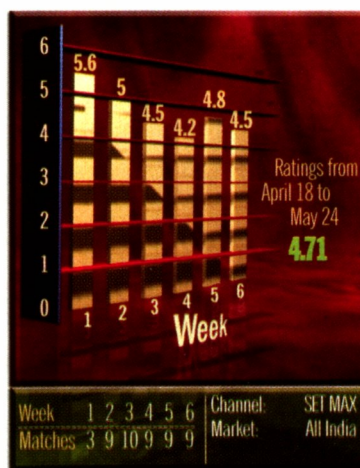
visible and thus viable will involve franchises supporting charities and getting involved in the local community and becoming a part of its cultural life. The ostensible aim is to develop bonds and to build loyalties with their fans even in the 10 month long off-season.

Even at the height of the IPL, bombarded by polyester T-shirts and television promos featuring rotund businessmen, India could not be tied down to a script around this 'loyalty' business. Mumbai ferociously booed anyone on the other side, but two workers from a textile factory sauntering past the Mohali stadium did not want to support the Kings XI Punjab. Chennai was their choice because it was M.S. Dhoni's team.

Bangalore native S. Sukumar distanced himself from the stuttering Royal Challengers, backing Punjab because Yuvraj Singh was a favourite. Friends Jas Kiran and Renu Kannan, kept going to matches in Mohali as the team was winning, tickets were easy to get and it was a chance to catch up. Accompanying them was Gursheer Singh, 11 who wore the Kings XI T-shirt and was sure his team would win the league. It is this demographic the IPL hopes will become die-hard fans a decade later.

Confusing huge crowd turnouts with the growth of team loyalty, though says IPL CEO Sundar Raman, is being

IPL TV RATINGS



Graphic by PRASHANT CHAUDHARY

Source: TAM Peoplemeter System

2
the number of
local players
hired by the
Rajasthan
Royals. They
played 8 over-
seas and 9 out-
station signings.

27
contracted
Indians didn't
play a match,
the most, 6,
with Chennai.